



SkillHub Education

NCFE LMS

Student Guide

An operational manual for learners. Signing in, uploading evidence, signing off completed assessments, and tracking work hours.

Version 1.0

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Production URL <https://ncfe-lms.onrender.com>

Awarding body NCFE / CACHE

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1. Overview

NCFE LMS is the SkillHub Learning Management System for UK vocational qualifications. It supports the full assessment lifecycle from learner onboarding through to IQA sign-off across four roles: **admin**, **assessor**, **student/learner**, and **IQA**. This guide covers the **student** role specifically.

Where you fit in the data model

Centre → Qualification → Unit → Learning Outcome → Assessment Criterion

User (with role) ■ Enrolment ■ Assessment ■ Evidence ■ IQA Decision

An **Enrolment** links a student to a qualification under a specific assessor and cohort. An **Assessment** sits inside an enrolment and maps one or more evidence files to one or more Assessment Criteria.

Production URL

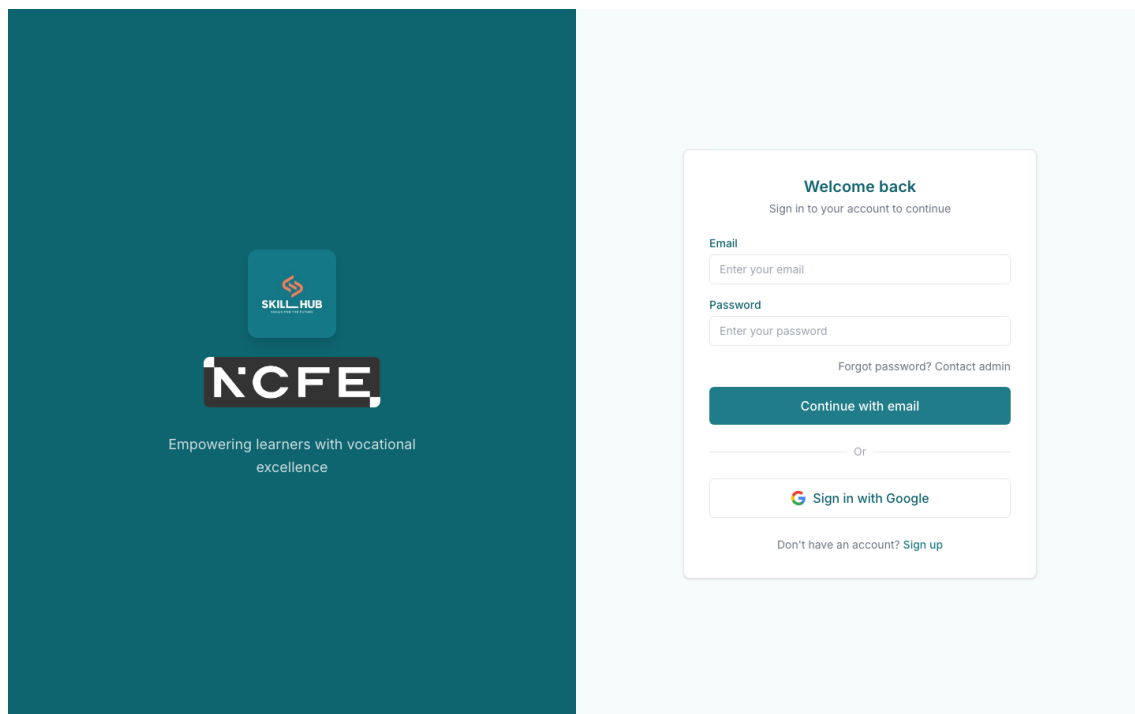
<https://ncfe-lms.onrender.com>

Where to get help

All account, password, and enrolment questions go to your centre administrator. Self-service password reset is intentionally disabled — admin holds password ownership by design.

2. Signing in

Open <https://ncfe-lms.onrender.com/sign-in>, enter your email and password, click **Continue with email**.

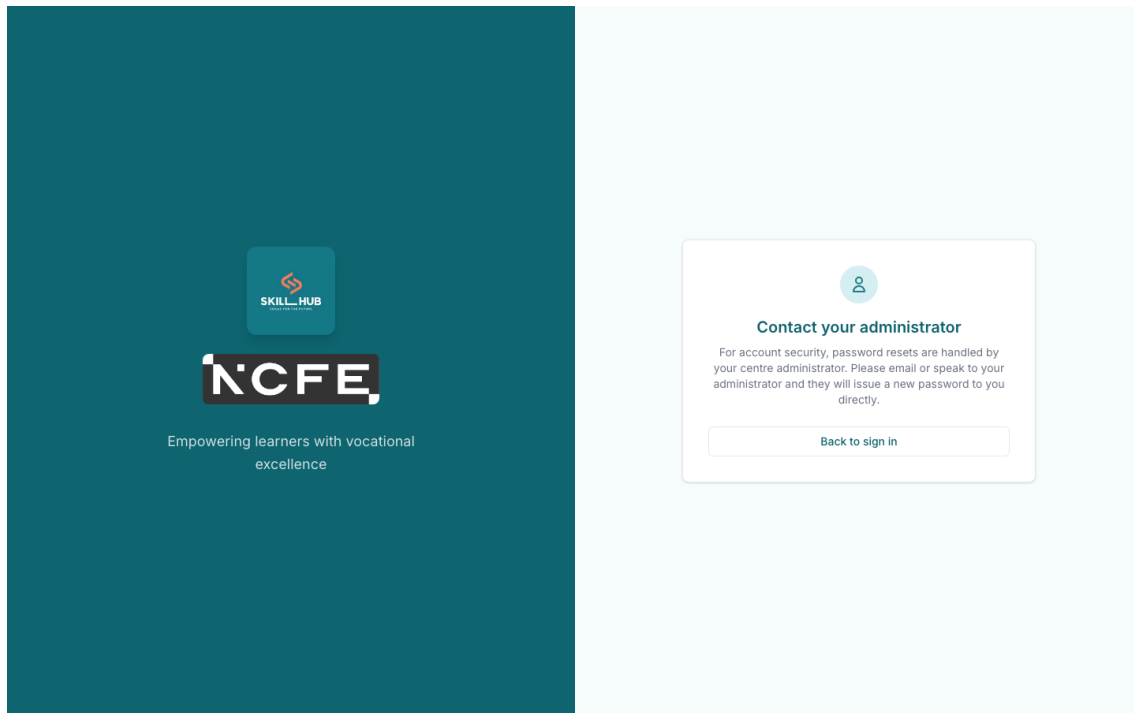


Sign-in page

Where each role lands after sign-in

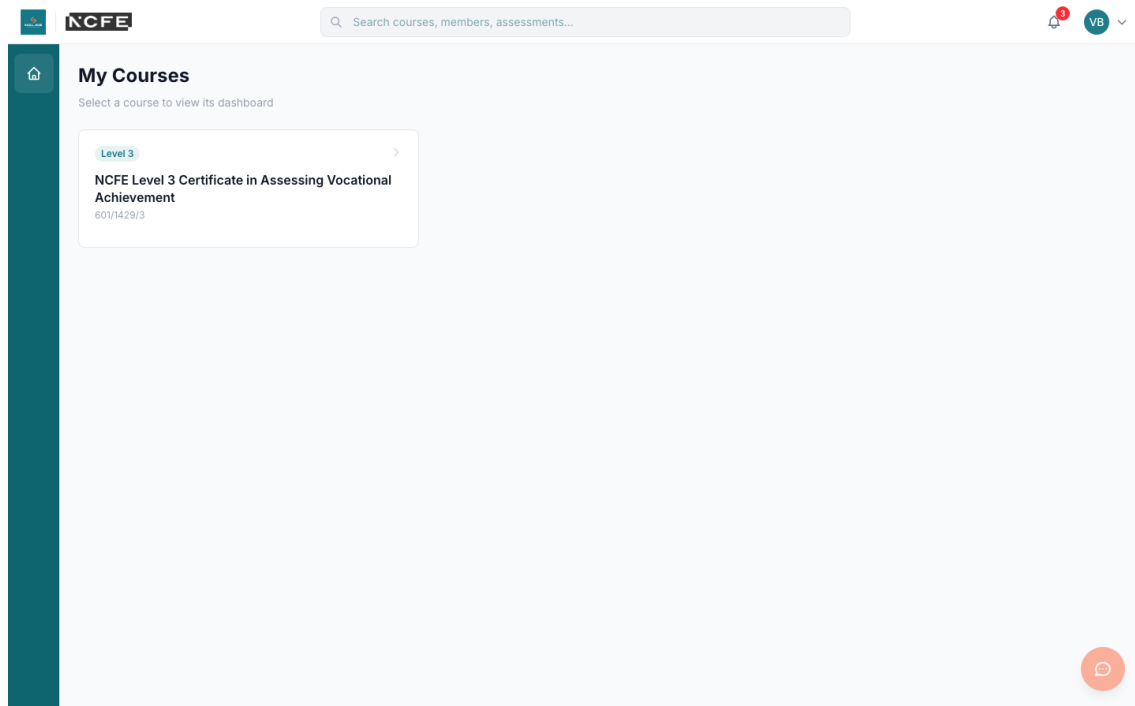
Role	Lands on
Admin	/admin/dashboard
Assessor	/c (course list)
Student	/c (course list)
IQA	/dashboard (IQA home)

Forgot your password? Click **Forgot password? Contact admin** on the sign-in page. You will see a contact-administrator notice. Self-service password reset is disabled by design. Email your centre administrator and they will issue a new password.



Forgot-password notice

3. Student tasks



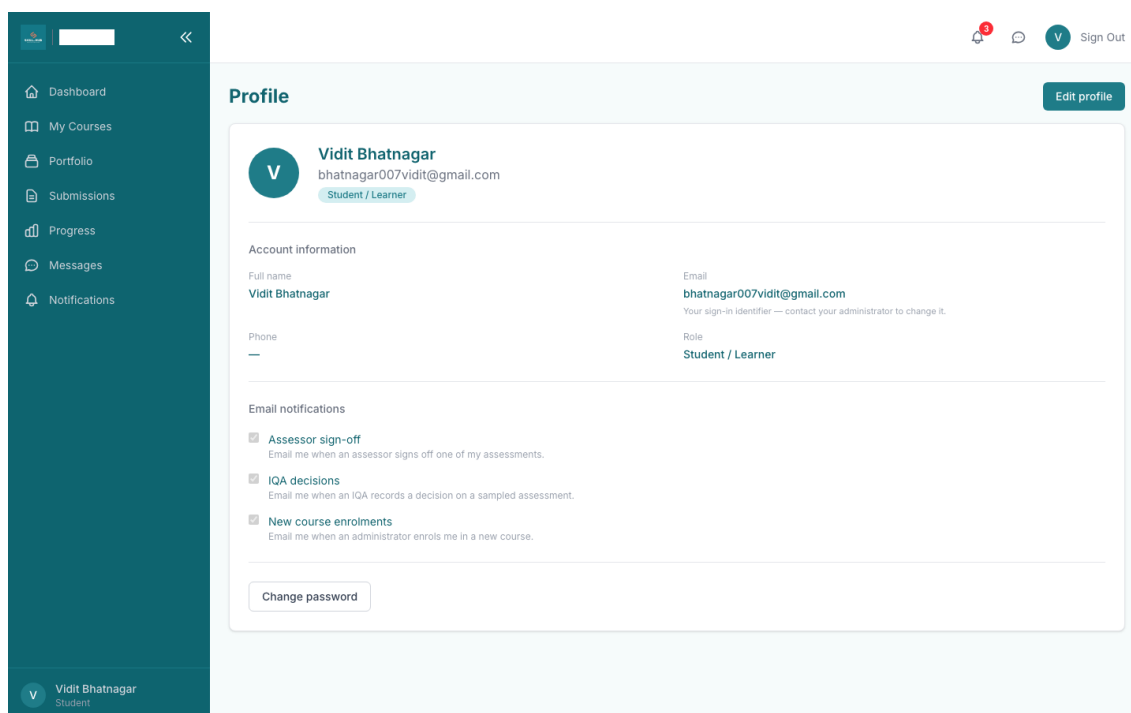
Course list at /c

After signing in you land on **/c** — your enrolment list. Click into a course card to enter that course's dashboard. The left sidebar (8 icons) is your main navigation.

Sidebar reference

Icon	Page	Purpose
■	Home	Overview of recent activity in this course
✓	Assessment	View assessments your assessor has set up and sign them off
■	Progress	Drill into your Units → LOs → Criteria → linked assessments
■	Portfolio	Upload and manage your evidence files
■	Course Documents	Documents your assessor has shared
■	Personal Documents	Your own private docs
■	Materials	Learning materials
■	Work Hours	Log your work hours; see the required total

3.1 Your profile and notifications



Profile at /profile

/profile lets you:

- Edit your **name** and **phone**. (Email is your sign-in identifier — to change it, ask your centre administrator.)
- Upload an **avatar** — PNG / JPEG / WEBP / GIF, up to 2 MB.
- Toggle email notifications on or off, individually:
 - **Assessor sign-off** — emailed when your assessor publishes an assessment for you to sign.
 - **IQA decisions** — emailed when an IQA records a decision on your assessment.
 - **New course enrolments** — emailed when admin enrolls you in a new course.

Forgot your password? Self-service password reset is disabled by design. Email your centre administrator and ask them to reset it for you. They will send you a new password to sign in with — keep that one until they reset it again.

3.2 Upload portfolio evidence

- 1 Sidebar → **Portfolio**.
- 2 Click **Upload Evidence**, pick the file (PDF / DOCX / image / video / audio — see file limits on the next page).
- 3 Fill a clear **label** (e.g. "PDF observation notes from shift on 12 Mar"). The label is what your assessor sees first.
- 4 Pick the **unit** the evidence belongs to.
- 5 Click **Upload**. Large videos go directly to S3 via a presigned URL — files up to 144 MB have been verified end-to-end.

- 6 After upload the evidence appears in your portfolio with status *draft*.
- 7 Click **Submit** to flip it to *submitted* — your assessor can now map it to an assessment.

Video thumbnails. When you upload a video, the server automatically generates a 1-second snapshot as a thumbnail. The thumbnail then renders alongside the video in your portfolio so you can identify recordings at a glance. If the codec is unusual or the conversion times out, the upload still succeeds and a generic file icon is shown instead.

3.3 Sign off an assessment

- 1 When your assessor publishes an assessment you receive an in-app notification (and an email if you have not opted out).
- 2 Sidebar → **Assessment** → click into the assessment.
- 3 Review the mapped criteria, the linked evidence, and your assessor's **Remark**.
- 4 Click the **Sign off** button to confirm. The status updates.

3.4 Log your work hours

- 1 Sidebar → **Work Hours**.
- 2 Use the day navigator to pick a date.
- 3 Click **+ New**, enter hours and minutes plus a one-line note.
- 4 Save. The entry appears in the day's list; the daily total updates at the bottom.

Required work hours. Some qualifications have a target total set by the admin. When set, a progress bar at the top of the Work Hours page shows your **logged hours / required hours** with a percentage. The bar turns green and shows 'Requirement met' when you reach the target.

4. Reference

4.1 File upload limits

Setting	Value
Max single file size	2 GB
Avatar limit	2 MB (PNG / JPEG / WEBP / GIF)
Documents	.pdf, .doc, .docx, .xls, .xlsx, .ppt, .pptx, .txt
Images	.png, .jpg, .jpeg, .gif, .webp
Video / audio	.mp4, .mov, .avi, .mp3, .wav, .m4a
Other	.zip

4.2 Email notifications you receive

Event	Can you opt out?
Welcome email when account is created	No (always-on)
Password reset by admin	No
Resend welcome email by admin	No
Your assessor publishes an assessment	Yes
An IQA records a decision on your assessment	Yes
You're enrolled in a new course	Yes

Toggle the opt-outs in **/profile** → **Edit profile**. The next event of that type skips you. The system never blocks the originating action because of an email failure — your assessment still gets signed off, you just won't be emailed about it.

4.3 Statuses you'll see

Status	Where	What it means
draft	Evidence in portfolio	Uploaded but not yet submitted
submitted	Evidence in portfolio	Submitted; your assessor can now map it
assessed	Evidence in portfolio	Linked to a published assessment
draft	Assessment	Assessor is still working on it
published	Assessment	Sent to you for sign-off
published_modified	Assessment	Assessor edited after publishing — re-published is pending
enrolled / in_progress	Enrolment	Your active courses
completed	Enrolment	You finished this qualification
withdrawn	Enrolment	You're no longer on this course

5. Student FAQ

Q. I forgot my password — how do I reset it?

A. Email your centre administrator. Self-service password reset is disabled by design. The administrator will reset your password and send you a new one. Sign in with that and keep using it until they reset it again.

Q. Can I change my own password?

A. No — by design, your administrator owns password ownership. If you want a new password, contact your administrator and ask them to reset it for you. They will send you the new password to use.

Q. What happens when I sign in for the first time?

A. You go directly to your course list at /c. There is no first-login password change step — use the password your administrator gave you.

Q. My welcome email landed in spam. Is that normal?

A. It can happen until the centre's email domain is fully verified. Check your spam / junk folder, mark the email as 'not spam', and future welcome / sign-off / IQA emails should land in the inbox.

Q. Can I be on more than one course at the same time?

A. Yes. Each course you're enrolled in shows as a card on /c. Your evidence portfolio, work hours, and progress are scoped to whichever course you're inside.

Q. My video uploaded but there's no thumbnail. What happened?

A. The server tries to extract a 1-second snapshot at upload time. It quietly skips when the codec is unusual, the file is malformed, or extraction takes longer than 30 seconds. The upload itself still succeeded — only the preview fell back to the generic file icon. If the file looks healthy and you want a thumbnail, re-encode it as standard H.264 / mp4 and re-upload.

Q. Can I delete an assessment my assessor created?

A. No — assessors and admins create and delete assessments. You can delete your own evidence files (while they're still in *draft* status) and you can sign off published assessments your assessor sends you.

Q. How do I stop getting sign-off emails?

A. /profile → **Edit profile** → toggle off the **Assessor sign-off** checkbox. The next time your assessor publishes an assessment, you won't receive an email — but you'll still see the in-app notification when you sign in.

Q. Can I edit my email address?

A. No — your email is your sign-in identifier. Your centre administrator can update it for you from /admin/users → Edit.

Q. Where do I see how many work hours I've logged?

A. Sidebar → **Work Hours**. The list shows each entry with the daily total at the bottom. If your qualification has a Required Work Hours target, a progress bar at the top shows percent complete.